

August 20, 2026

Molina Healthcare of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Lonnie Von (MRN MUSC3090378), Claim MUSC-E622-3

Patient	Lonnie Von (DOB 1950-08-03)
MRN	MUSC3090378
Member ID / Group	MOL918865725 / GRP-17484
Claim number	MUSC-E622-3
Date of service	2026-04-26
Procedure billed	CPT 45378 — Colonoscopy, flexible; diagnostic
Primary diagnosis	S72.001A — Fracture of unspecified part of neck of femur, initial encounter
Denied amount	\$5,996.94
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-27

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health submits this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Lonnie Von (MRN: MUSC3090378, Member ID: MOL918865725) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-E622-3 for services rendered on April 26, 2026, at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care. Molina Healthcare of South Carolina denied the claim under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests a full reconsideration and reversal of the denial.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Von is a 76-year-old male with a documented history of osteoporosis, active since 2011, for which he has been maintained on alendronic acid 10 mg oral tablet since March 2011. He sustained a pathological fracture associated with his osteoporosis, with an onset recorded in February 2021, and has been managed with acetaminophen/hydrocodone bitartrate and naproxen sodium since that time. His medical history is further notable for a history of cardiac arrest, adding to the complexity of his overall clinical profile. The colonoscopy performed by Dr. Priya N. Raghavan (NPI 1669504132) on April 26, 2026, was billed under CPT 45378 at an on-campus outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22). The patient's prior procedure history includes a colonoscopy performed in July 2020 and an earlier colonoscopy in July 2015, establishing a pattern of ongoing colorectal surveillance in this elderly patient.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The payer's denial rests on the assertion that the submitted documentation does not establish medical necessity for the diagnosis reported. MUSC Health acknowledges that the primary diagnosis code submitted on the claim, S72.001A (fracture of unspecified part of neck of femur, initial encounter), does not on its face reflect a colorectal indication. However, this does not negate the clinical necessity of the colonoscopy itself. Mr. Von is a 76-year-old male with multiple active comorbidities, including long-standing osteoporosis and a history of cardiac arrest, and has an established history of periodic colonoscopic surveillance as evidenced by procedures performed in 2015 and 2020. The interval between the 2020 and 2026 procedures is consistent with surveillance intervals recognized under generally accepted gastroenterological standards for patients of his age and risk profile.

To the extent the denial was influenced by a perceived mismatch between the procedure and the reported diagnosis codes, MUSC Health is prepared to submit supplemental documentation from the treating provider, Dr. Raghavan, clarifying the clinical indication for the procedure. A coding discrepancy, if present, does not constitute a basis for a medical necessity denial; it is a correctable billing matter that should be addressed through a request for additional documentation rather than an outright denial with zero payment against a billed amount of \$5,996.94. MUSC Health further notes that Molina's own allowed amount of \$3,243.50 was calculated on this claim, suggesting the service itself falls within covered benefits, making the full denial to \$0.00 paid inconsistent with that contractual determination.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Molina Healthcare of South Carolina overturn the medical necessity denial for Claim MUSC-E622-3 and reprocess the claim for payment at the applicable contracted rate. If Molina requires additional clinical documentation, operative notes, or a letter of medical necessity from Dr. Raghavan to support this appeal, MUSC Health will provide those records promptly upon request. This appeal is submitted within the 90-day appeal window, prior to the stated deadline of August 27, 2026, and MUSC Health expects a written determination in accordance with Molina's appeal response obligations under South Carolina Medicaid managed care regulations.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record